

I often thought of the profits I didn't make as a kind of subjunctive contribution to the Bhopali cause.

I was determined to shun IBM out of sympathy for South African blacks, since at the start of my journey IBM was still active in that country. Since IBM had gone nowhere as a stock, I was glad I'd had the courage to resist it. One of my former brokers once recommended Philip Morris at \$60 and I gave up doubling my money there—which I hope the victims of smoking will also appreciate. This leads me to Useful Tip Number 21:

**The better a stock does, the more ethical you feel
for not having bought it**

Centuries ago, there was no such thing as an ethical investment. In those simplistic days, money itself was thought to be unethical, and loaning it out at interest was sinful *ipso facto*. Even into the 1920s, there were few ethical distinctions among stocks, since Wall Street was a known den of thieves and owning any stock was thought to be no better than playing cards for money. In those years, colleges and universities did debate whether to accept tainted endowments from the Rockefellers and other robber barons. Inevitably, though, they voted yes. Most were comforted by the emperor Vespasian's reply to critics of his public-toilet monopoly: *pecunia non olet*, "money doesn't smell."

Only in the 1930s did we begin to see a widespread acceptance of stock portfolios as respectable in general. This marked the beginning of distinguishing one stock as morally superior to another. Religious institutions were the first to act on these distinctions. Certain Catholic dioceses wouldn't invest in birth-control stocks, Protestant denominations refused to hold liquor stocks, Christian Scientists stayed away from medical stocks. Eventually, the union pension funds followed suit, avoiding stocks in union-busting corporations.

It wasn't until the early 1970s that large numbers of individuals began to invest ethically. That's when ex-hippies, radicals, and protesters came into money. Many who inherited trust funds or acquired other sizable sources of income refused to support uneth-